JORGE E. ZAVALA

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EDUCATION

HUMBOLDT UNIVERSITY, Berlin, Germany *September 2025 - Present*
Doctoral Researcher. Ph.D. candidate in Political Science
Dissertation title: *"Breaking Cycles of Violence: Investigating the Intergenerational Transmission of Conflict, and Violence and Understanding the Determinants of Effective Policy Pathways for Sustainable Peace and Development"*
Supervisors: Macartan Humphreys, Anselm Hager, Alexandra Scacco

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO, Chicago, IL, USA *August 2022 - June 2024*
Master of Public Policy, with Honors (GPA: 3.8)
Master's Thesis: *"Profiling Extremism Hotspots: Identifying High-Risk Provinces for Violent Extremism in Burkina Faso Using Machine Learning"*
Supervisor: Benjamin Krause

PONTIFICIA UNIVERSIDAD CATÓLICA DE CHILE, Santiago de Chile, Chile *August 2021 - December 2021*
Impact Evaluation of Programs and Public Policies Diploma (GPA: 3.6)
Graduating Project: *"Impact Evaluation Pre-Analysis Plan for the UNPD's program "Impulso Local"*, in Colombia"

UNIVERSIDAD DEL PACÍFICO, Lima, Peru *January 2013 - December 2017*
B.Sc. in Economics, Minor in Public Economics
Graduating Thesis: *"Public and Private Investment in Local Development as Mediators of International Price Shocks and Mining Conflicts in Peru"*
Supervisor: Matthew Bird

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

WZB Berlin Social Science Research Center
Doctoral Research Fellow *July 2025 - Present*

- Part of the Institutions and Political Inequality department at the WZB Berlin Social Science Research Center
- In charge of designing and conducting research projects on the department's agenda around political violence, conflict, development economics and peacebuilding.

Equilibrium Social Development Consulting
Quantitative Research Consultant *June 2024 - September 2025*

- Led quantitative research projects and consulting services related to Migration, Water and Sanitation, Access to Health, and Financial Inclusion in Colombia, Paraguay, and Peru.

Fundación Capital
Head of Data & Research (previously M&E Coordinator and Quantitative Research Specialist) *August 2019 - July 2026*

- Designed and executed quantitative results analysis and impact evaluation strategies of 30 different technology-based international development projects in partnership with national and local governments, private financial institutions, and international cooperation across 10 countries with a reach of approximately 400,000 beneficiaries. Academic articles and technical notes authored.
- Led design and implementation of Performance Management Systems at the organization's core to strengthen monitoring and evaluation work across +15 Fundación Capital projects. Conducted an organization-wide training regarding design, management, and use of Performance Management Systems for more than 60 project managers and field staff.

The World Bank: DIME
Research Analyst; Short-Term Consultant *June 2023 - August 2023 / July 2024 - July 2025*

- Member of the Development Impact Evaluation Department at The World Bank as an Economist. Provided technical support on the endline data processing and analysis of the impact evaluation of the water governance RCT "Maji Endelevu" in Tanzania. Led the production of the academic paper.

Center for the Economics of Human Development at the University of Chicago
Graduate Research Assistant *August 2022 - September 2023*

· Guided the elaboration of the research plan of a Home Visiting initiative targeted toward underserved families in situations of economic vulnerability. Designed the experimental design (RCT) to evaluate the program rigorously and guided the performance management system's elaboration to strengthen its monitoring during the 5 years of implementation.

International Initiative for Impact Evaluation
Research Associate: Consultant *April 2022 - August 2023*

· Conducted impact evaluation analysis of two poverty graduation and food security programs in Colombia and Guatemala involving +20,000 participants using a Regression Discontinuity Design and experimental approaches (RCTs)
· Improved implementation of data transparency and reproducibility protocols from +20 impact evaluations and research projects undertaken by 3ie and third parties.

Peruvian Society of Foreign Trade
Economic Research Analyst *June 2019 - August 2022*

· Authored 71 weekly articles (to date) on political economy, foreign trade, infrastructure, and economic and social competitiveness issues, among other topics, with a high impact on public policy decisions, released in institutional journal. Managed collaborations with policymakers from public entities to strengthen the use of data and evidence in the design of economic and social policy
· Guided econometric analysis based on public data regarding Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) competitiveness and formalization, Tourism sector competitiveness, and Quality and efficacy of public expenditure. Created the "Regional Tourism Competitiveness Index" and the "Formal Capacities Index of MSEs",

Universidad del Pacífico Research Center
Graduate Research Analyst *August 2018 - March 2020*

· Led academic research and consulting work for public and private organizations regarding the quantitative and qualitative evaluation of development programs and social investment in Latin America with Professor Ph.D. Matthew Bird.
· Co-designed and performed impact evaluation of the Collective Reparations Program of communities victims of terrorism in Peru using a Regression Discontinuity Design (RDD) (Forthcoming paper).
· Co-developed and performed impact evaluation of technology-based financial inclusion programs (RCTs) for women in rural Mexico, Honduras, and Colombia (Published paper).
· Conducted quantitative analysis of the intergenerational transmission of armed conflict effects in Peru (Forthcoming paper).
· Co-developed and performed mixed methods strategies for diagnosis and measurement of organizational capacity of institutional philanthropy in five countries in Latin America with university-funded trips for book launch events, seminars, and work meetings (Published book chapter).

Instiglio
Projects analyst *January 2018 - August 2018*

· Improved statistical analysis processes and design strategy of Result-Based Financing and Performance Management projects for international development programs and public policies in Peru, Colombia, and Liberia.
· Guided and designed in-depth quantitative analysis strategies for impact evaluations and results verification strategies of Results-based Financing projects with a focus on education and rural development in Latin America.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Hertie School
Graduate Teaching Assistant *January 2026 - Present*

· GRAD-C6-2001: Statistics II: Statistical Modeling and Causal Inference
· GRAD-C5: Statistics I: Inference and Regression

ProImpacto - School of Economics and Public Policy
Lecturer *June 2024 - September 2024 / September 2025 - October 2025*

· Randomized Controlled Trials
· Causal Machine Learning

· Impact Evaluation Methods for Public Policy Analysis
· Causal Mediation Analysis

Equilibirum Social Development Consulting
Lecturer - Diploma on Data Science *August 2024*

· Unsupervised Machine Learning

University of Chicago
Graduate Teaching Assistant *August 2023 - June 2024*

· Math and Coding Camp
· PBPL 20000 Economics for Public Policy - Prof. Carolyn Sloane
· PPHA 32310 Advanced Microeconomics for Public Policy - Prof. Steven Durlauf
· PPHA 31302 Advanced Statistics for Data Analysis II - Prof. Bruce Meyer
· PPHA 58002 Data Analytics II: Introduction to Program Evaluation - Prof. Christopher Clapp
· PPHA 34600 Program Evaluation - Prof. Fiona Burlig
· PPHA 41850 Modern Survey Research Methods and Techniques - Prof. John Bremer

Universidad del Pacífico
Undergraduate Teaching Assistant *March 2016 - December 2017*

· Econometrics I - Prof. Pablo Lavado

PUBLICATIONS

Selected Work in Progress

· Chirikure, Nora; Humphreys, Macartan; Kresimon, Madalena; Scacco, Alexandra; Zavala, Jorge. "Evaluating CBT Group Interventions in Conflict-Affected Nigerian Communities".
· Beber, Bernd; Scacco, Alexandra; Zavala, Jorge. "The Myth of the Misinformed Migrant? Survey Insights from Nigeria's Irregular Migration Epicenter". Currently under R&R.
· Zavala, Jorge. "Informing Transitional Justice: A Cluster-Randomized Pilot on Knowledge, Trust, and Civic Attitudes in Post-Conflict Peru".
· Zavala, Jorge; Srebot, Carla. "Coaching the Match: Experimental Evidence from Chatbot assistance and AI augmentation in Mozambique's Gig Economy".
· Cardozo, Angélica; Zavala, Jorge. "Digital Bridges for Financial Inclusion: The Role of Public Digital Infrastructure in Empowering Migrant Women and Facilitating Remittances in Colombia".
· Arrieta, Johar; Zavala, Jorge. "Reallocation, Firm Dynamics, and the Advanced-Economy Trap: Evidence from German Establishment Data".

Author/Co-author

· Bird, Matthew; Dumez, Ana María; Zavala, Jorge. "Are Collective Reparations Transitional or Transformational? Migration and Policy Feedback in Peru." Forthcoming 2026.
· Zavala, Jorge (May 2022). "Peru ranks 67 out of 76 countries in the Green Future Index in 2021". Negocios Internacionales, 26(292), 37-39
· Zavala, Jorge (January 2022). "The mining sector led the Peruvian exports' growth between January and November of 2021". Negocios Internacionales, 26(288), 33-35
· Zavala, Jorge (November 2021). "The 67.7% increase in textile exports between January and September of 2021 coincides with the solid recovery of Peruvian foreign trade". Negocios Internacionales, 25(287), 39-41
· Zavala, Jorge (August 2021). "The deterioration of the formal capabilities and productivity of the micro and small enterprises in Peru, the pending agenda of the Government". Negocios Internacionales, 25(284),10-19
· Zavala, Jorge (June 2021). "The number of small and micro enterprises in Peru decreased in 48.8% in 2020 and informality rates climbed up to 85
· Bird, Matthew; Zavala, Jorge (Forthcoming) "Trust in the ability or ability to trust: Towards an index of local governance in Peru". in Gonzalo Delgado, ed., "Mining in Peru by 2030: Challenges and opportunities" (Lima: Editorial de la Universidad del Pacifico, in preparation)
· Gómez, Franz; Montes, Alejandra, Navarrete, Juan; Ortiz, Victor & Zavala, Jorge (2020). "Agricultural insurance in Latin America and the Caribbean: Challenges and lessons from innovative experiences". Brasilia: International Fund for Agricultural Development-IFAD

- Zavala, Jorge (November 2020). "The improvement of tourism competitiveness of Peru should be promoted by identifying and focusing on the particular needs of each region". Negocios Internacionales, 24(275),16-18

Research Assistant

- Celhay, Pablo; Martinez, Sebastián. Impact Evaluation of the ADN Dignidad Program: Understanding the Impact of a Humanitarian Cash Transfer (HCT) Program in Colombia. 3ie Impact Evaluation Report 137. New Delhi: International Initiative for Impact Evaluation (3ie), 2023.
- Attanasio, Orazio; Bird, Matthew; et. al (2019). "Freeing Financial Education via Tablets: Experimental Evidence from Colombia". NBER Working Paper 25929
- Bird, Matthew & León, Vicente (2019). "A will in search of a way: philanthropy in education in Peru". Philanthropy in Education 123-139
- Aninat, Magdalena; Berger, Gabriel; Bird, Matthew et. al (2019). "Towards the strengthening of institutional philanthropy in Latin America". Lima: Fondo editorial de la Universidad del Pacifico
- Bird, Matthew; León, Vicente (2018). "Towards a new philanthropy in Peru", Lima, Perú: Universidad del Pacifico editorial fund
- Bird, Matthew (2020). "Financial Education, Couple's Communication, and Gender Norms: Explaining the Mixed Effects of Women's Empowerment on Intra-household Bargaining". BBVA Center for Financial Education and Capability

CONFERENCES

- Panelist, *"Building Inclusion in Digital Public Infrastructure: Research from Global DPI Insights Community,"* Financial Inclusion Week 2026, Center for Financial Inclusion (CFI). Virtual. October 6, 2026.
- Presenter, *"Recognition-through-Information? Transitional Justice Knowledge, Legitimacy, and Rule-of-Law Orientations in Post-Conflict Peru: Evidence from a Randomized Saturation Pilot,"* Session 2A: State, Institutions, and Governance, 2026 Annual Meeting of the Peruvian Economic Association, Universidad del Pacífico. Lima, Peru. July 22–23, 2026.
- Presenter, *"Are Collective Reparations Transitional or Transformational? Migration and Policy Feedback in Peru,"* Session 7: Migration, 2nd Junior Workshop on Economics of Latin America, Freie Universität Berlin. Berlin, Germany. July 9–10, 2026. Also served as discussant in Session 4: Trade, Environment, and Resources.
- Presenter, *"Are Collective Reparations Transitional or Transformational? Migration and Policy Feedback in Peru,"* Session 5A: Migration and Regional Development, 16th Armenian Economic Association Annual Meeting, American University of Armenia. Yerevan, Armenia. June 29–July 1, 2026.
- Panelist, *"Building Inclusion: Identity, Payments, and the Real Cost of Digital Public Infrastructure,"* UN Open Source Week, United Nations Headquarters. New York, USA. June 24, 2026.
- Presenter at the "Conflict & Change PhD Workshop 2026", organized by the University College London Department of Political Science. London, UK. May 18-19, 2026
- Presenter, *"Are Collective Reparations Transitional or Transformational? Migration and Policy Feedback in Peru,"* Session 7: Inequality, Social Mobility, and Household Decisions, 4th Milan PhD Economics Workshop, Bocconi University. Milan, Italy. May 12–13, 2026.
- Presenter, *"Recognition-through-Information? Transitional Justice Knowledge, Legitimacy, and Rule-of-Law Orientations in Post-Conflict Peru: Evidence from a Randomized Saturation Pilot,"* Early-Stage Feedback Session, Berlin Development Workshop, ESMT Berlin. Berlin, Germany. May 11, 2026.
- Presenter at the "Empirical Studies in Conflict Research" Annual Meeting 2025, organized by Princeton University, Emory University, The University of Chicago, and UC San Diego. Washington D.C., USA. October 8th-10th, 2025.
- Presenter at the event "2024 KDIS-WB DIME 5th Development Impact Conference", organized by the KDI School of Public Policy and Management and the World Bank's Development Impact Group. Seoul, Republic of Korea. November 14th-15th, 2024.
- Speaker at the event "APEC Workshop: Prospect Analysis for Sustainable Development of Tourism in Remote Areas of APEC Economies", organized by the APEC and the Federal Agency for Tourism of the Russian Federation. Manila, Philippines. October 10th-11th, 2019.
- Speaker at the event "APEC Canada Workshop: Competitiveness and Social Innovation for Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises.", organized by Kunan, Asia Pacific Foundation of Canada, Peruvian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, and Peruvian Ministry of Production. Lima, Peru. September 14, 2019.
- Panel Discussion at the event "Bringing Financial Education to Scale through Digital Transformation: The Experience of LISTA.", organized by the Research Center of the Universidad del Pacifico, Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA), and Fundacion Capital. Lima, Peru. February 18, 2019.

GRANTS & FUNDING

Source	Project	Year	Amount
Center for Financial Inclusion	Digital Bridges for Financial Inclusion: The Role of Public Digital Infrastructure in Empowering Migrant Women and Facilitating Remittances in Colombia	2025–2026	USD 40,000
WZB Berlin Social Science Center	Informing Transitional Justice: A Cluster-Randomized on Knowledge, Trust, and Civic Attitudes in Post-Conflict Peru	2025–2026	USD 10,000
Armenian Economic Association	16th Annual Meeting Conference Travel Grant	2026	EUR 100

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Softwares Stata, R / RStudio, ArcGIS, Python, LaTeX, Eviews, PowerBI, Tableau, VisualBasic, Microsoft Office Suite

Languages Spanish (native), English (advanced), Portuguese (intermediate), French (intermediate)